

Independent component analysis

MATH70102 Unsupervised Learning

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In this notebook, we exemplify **independent component analysis** (ICA) by applying it to an audio file that mimics the cocktail-party problem.

```
In [1]: import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import numpy as np
from IPython.display import Audio
from scipy.io import wavfile
from sklearn.decomposition import PCA, FastICA

plt.style.use("ggplot")
```

We will load and play a short audio file (4 seconds), which was created by mixing two clips of the speech track from one of the lecture videos. This file is **in stereo** (two channels) with **sampling frequency** 44.1 kHz (i.e., 44100 samples per second) and **bit depth** 16 (i.e., $2^{16} = 65536$ possible levels). The two speech tracks are placed slightly apart in the stereo field. This creates a linear mixture that conforms exactly to the key assumption of ICA.

```
In [2]: rate, data = wavfile.read("Mix-for-ICA.wav")
print("Sampling frequency:", rate, "Hz")
print("Data shape:", data.shape)
print("Data value type:", data.dtype)
```

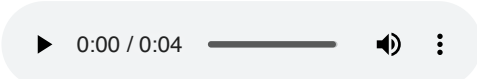
Sampling frequency: 44100 Hz

Data shape: (176400, 2)

Data value type: int16

/var/folders/mt/gq61qprx3xn80cyfh7v7vmzm0000gp/T/ipykernel_14172/1728291936.py:1: WavFileWarning: Chunk (non-data) not understood, skipping it.
rate, data = wavfile.read("Mix-for-ICA.wav")

```
In [3]: # Convert from 16-bit fixed point (np.int16) to 64-bit floating point (np.float64) and
# normalise values to range [-1, 1] (32768 = 2^16 / 2 is the largest possible value):
data = data.astype(np.float64) / 32768
data = data.T # IPython.display.Audio expects shape (2, n_samples) for stereo audio
Audio(data=data, rate=rate)
```

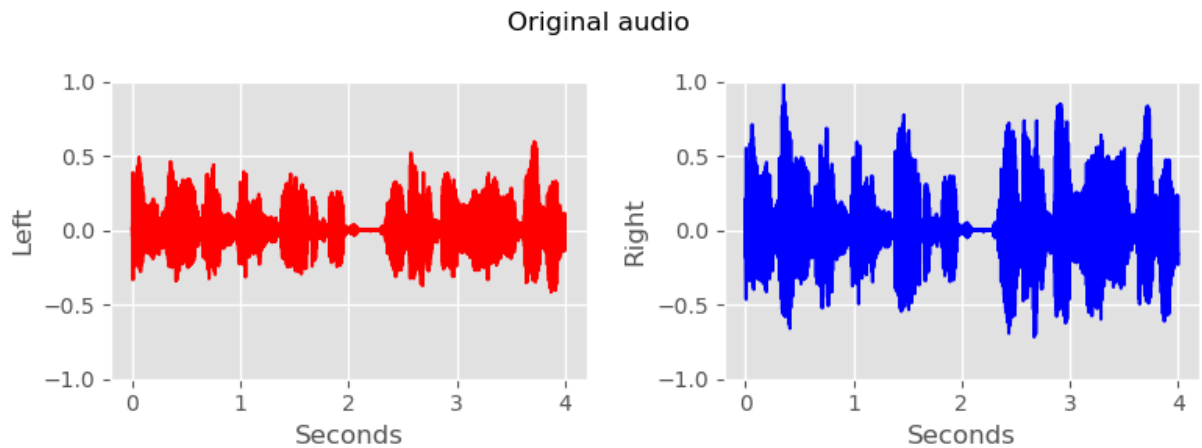
Out[3]: 

Let us also plot the waveforms of both left and right channels:

```
In [4]: fig, axs = plt.subplots(1, 2, figsize=(8, 3))

grid = np.arange(0, data.shape[1]) / rate
axs[0].plot(grid, data[0, :], color="red")
axs[0].set_xlabel("Seconds")
axs[0].set_ylabel("Left")
axs[0].set_ylim(-1.0, 1.0)
axs[1].plot(grid, data[1, :], color="blue")
axs[1].set_xlabel("Seconds")
axs[1].set_ylabel("Right")
axs[1].set_ylim(-1.0, 1.0)

fig.suptitle("Original audio")
plt.tight_layout()
plt.show()
```



We will first try to separate the speech tracks using **PCA**. After applying PCA, we normalise the channels:

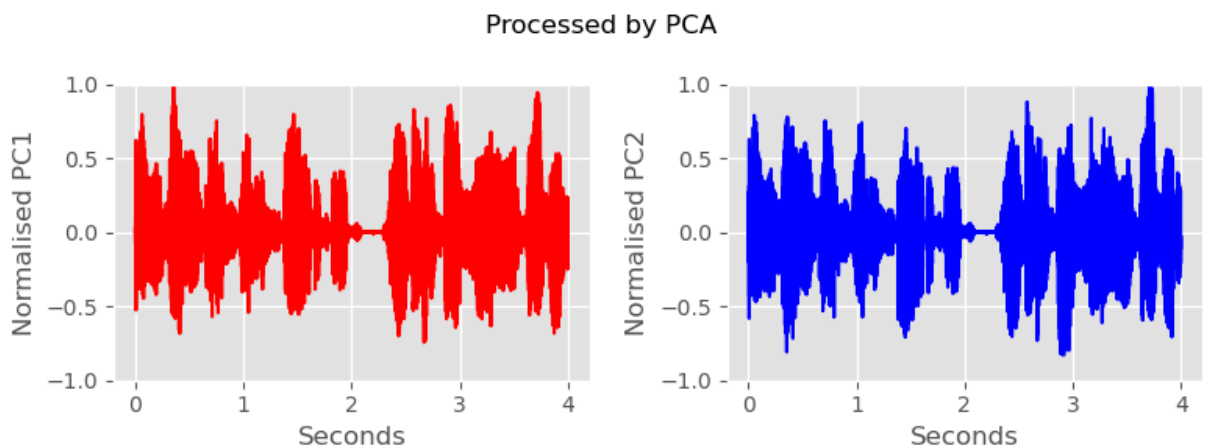
```
In [5]: pca = PCA()
data_pca = pca.fit_transform(data.T)
data_pca[:, 0] = data_pca[:, 0] / np.max(data_pca[:, 0])
data_pca[:, 1] = data_pca[:, 1] / np.max(data_pca[:, 1])
data_pca = data_pca.T
```

First plot them:

```
In [6]: fig, axs = plt.subplots(1, 2, figsize=(8, 3))

axs[0].plot(grid, data_pca[0, :], color="red")
axs[0].set_xlabel("Seconds")
axs[0].set_ylabel("Normalised PC1")
axs[0].set_ylim(-1.0, 1.0)
axs[1].plot(grid, data_pca[1, :], color="blue")
axs[1].set_xlabel("Seconds")
axs[1].set_ylabel("Normalised PC2")
axs[1].set_ylim(-1.0, 1.0)

fig.suptitle("Processed by PCA")
plt.tight_layout()
plt.show()
```



And then play them component by component. First PC1:

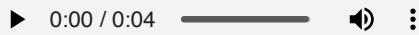
```
In [7]: Audio(data=data_pca[0, :], rate=rate)
```

Out[7]:

Then PC2:

```
In [8]: Audio(data=data_pca[1, :], rate=rate)
```

Out[8]:



It is clear that PCA is unable to separate the signals. We will then try **ICA**. The class `FastICA` from the module `sklearn.decomposition` performs the version of ICA seen in lectures. We normalise the resulting components (since their scaling is arbitrary anyway).

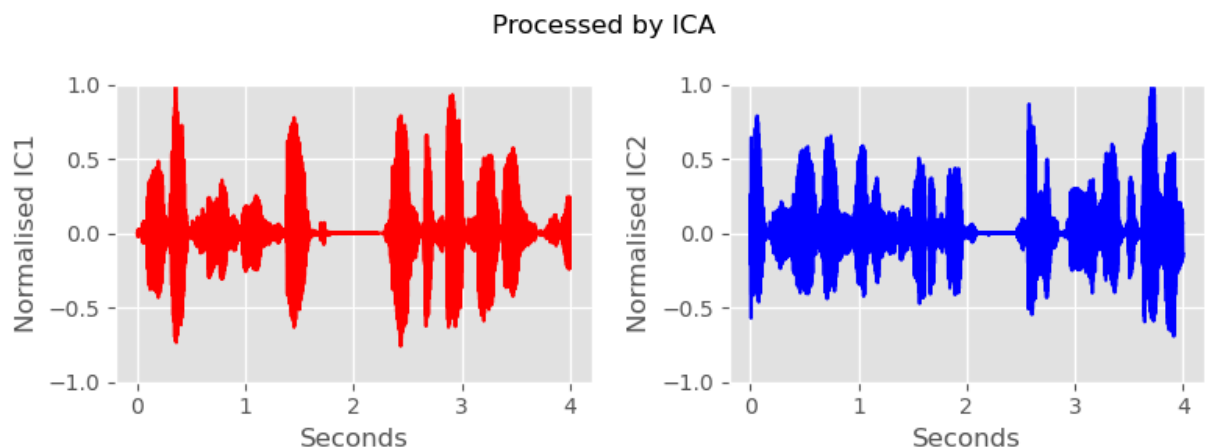
```
In [9]: ica = FastICA(whiten="unit-variance", random_state=12345)
data_ica = ica.fit_transform(data.T)
data_ica[:, 0] = data_ica[:, 0] / np.max(data_ica[:, 0])
data_ica[:, 1] = data_ica[:, 1] / np.max(data_ica[:, 1])
data_ica = data_ica.T
```

Let us plot the components:

```
In [10]: fig, axs = plt.subplots(1, 2, figsize=(8, 3))

axs[0].plot(grid, data_ica[0, :], color="red")
axs[0].set_xlabel("Seconds")
axs[0].set_ylabel("Normalised IC1")
axs[0].set_ylim(-1.0, 1.0)
axs[1].plot(grid, data_ica[1, :], color="blue")
axs[1].set_xlabel("Seconds")
axs[1].set_ylabel("Normalised IC2")
axs[1].set_ylim(-1.0, 1.0)

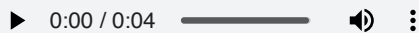
fig.suptitle("Processed by ICA")
plt.tight_layout()
plt.show()
```



They look reassuringly dissimilar. Let us play IC1:

```
In [11]: Audio(data=data_ica[0, :], rate=rate)
```

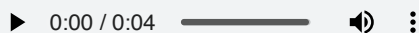
Out[11]:



And then IC2:

```
In [12]: Audio(data=data_ica[1, :], rate=rate)
```

Out[12]:



The separation is remarkably clear and artifact-free.